SMARTSPEND

Make every rupee count.

PROJECT PURPOSE | STUDENT PERSONAL FINANCE

A simple money companion for students

SmartSpend is a browser-based personal finance tracker that helps students record income and expenses, understand spending habits, plan a monthly budget, and keep more control over their money.

THE PROBLEM

Small daily purchases are easy to forget. Without a clear record, students can lose track of where their pocket money goes and run short before month-end.

THE SOLUTION

One clear dashboard brings transactions, balances, category charts, and budget warnings together, making everyday money decisions easier.

WHO IT IS FOR

Primarily college and university students managing pocket money, part-time income, travel, meals, shopping, and study costs. The same tool can also help anyone who wants lightweight personal expense tracking.

WHAT SMARTSPEND HELPS USERS DO

01	**See the full picture**	Compare monthly income, expenses, available balance, and savings rate.
02	**Keep useful records**	Add, search, filter, edit, and remove categorized transactions.
03	**Make patterns visible**	Review category spending and compare income with expenses over time.
04	**Stay within a plan**	Set a monthly expense limit and get a warning as spending approaches it.
05	**Take data with you**	Keep records in the browser and export transactions as a CSV file.

THE OUTCOME

Students can answer three practical questions at a glance: How much came in? Where did it go? How much can I still spend?

HOW THE PROJECT WORKS

A focused, beginner-friendly finance tool

The first version prioritizes fast entry, readable summaries, and practical feedback. No bank connection or account is required.

EXAMPLE STUDENT MONTH

A student records INR 5,000 in pocket money and monthly expenses of INR 1,500 for food, INR 800 for transport, INR 700 for shopping, and INR 500 for other needs.

INCOME	EXPENSES	REMAINING
INR 5,000	INR 3,500	INR 1,500

The dashboard calculates balance as income minus expenses. It also shows that 70% of the starting amount has been spent.

CORE FEATURES

Dashboard	Monthly income, spending, balance, and savings rate.
Transactions	Income or expense, amount, category, date, and description; searchable history with editing and deletion.
Charts	Category-wise expense breakdown and recent monthly income-versus-expense trends.
Budget manager	A user-set monthly expense limit with progress and near-limit / over-limit alerts.
Storage and export	Browser local storage plus CSV download for a portable transaction report.

TECHNOLOGY

HTML and CSS provide the responsive interface; JavaScript handles transactions, calculations, filtering, validation, and browser storage; Chart.js renders interactive visualizations; CSV provides a simple export format.

HOW SUCCESS IS MEASURED

- Income, expenses, and balance match the recorded transactions.
- Budget warnings appear at the intended thresholds.
- Records remain after a refresh in the same browser.
- Users can identify their highest-spending categories and export a CSV.

SCOPE NOTE

This first version stores data only in the browser on the current device. It does not sync across devices, provide cloud backup, or connect to bank accounts. Users should export important records regularly.